

Activity 17 Instruction Manual

Activity 17 | Topic 02 | C013 | Version v1.0

Purpose

You will calculate how communication complexity grows, then use GenAI to build a communications plan and adapt a single message for very different audiences.

Files used

- activity-guide.md and activity-guide.pdf - brief and source instructions
- prompts.pdf - reusable prompt and verification checklist
- mock-data.xlsx - safe fictional project data for practice

Expected output

A communications management plan and the same update written for three audiences.

Before you begin

1. Form the required group and assign one person to capture evidence.
2. Open mock-data.xlsx and review the title, note and column headings.
3. Open prompts.pdf beside your chosen GenAI tool. Do not upload confidential workplace data.

Detailed procedure

1. Calculate the communication channels in your project team using $N \times (N - 1) / 2$. For a team of 10 that is 45. Recalculate for 15 people and note how fast it grows.
2. Using your stakeholder register from Activity 4, prompt GenAI: 'Build a communications management plan. For each stakeholder specify: information needed, reason, format, level of detail, frequency, channel, and sender.'
3. Check for the failure mode: the AI will propose sending everything to everyone weekly. Cut it back to what each stakeholder genuinely needs, and use push vs pull deliberately - push for what must be read, pull (a dashboard or portal) for reference information.
4. Now write one piece of bad news - a two-week slip. Prompt GenAI to write it three ways: for the executive sponsor, for the delivery team, and for an external customer.
5. Compare the three against the Five Cs: Correct, Concise, Clear, Coherent, Controlled. Rewrite whichever version fails.
6. Check the sponsor version leads with the impact and the decision required, not with an explanation of what happened.
7. Identify which communication barriers apply in your project - language, cultural, physical, psychological, perceptual, information overload, jargon - and add one mitigation for each to your plan.
8. Share your three versions and explain what you changed between them and why.

Use the supplied mock data

Copy only the rows needed for the current step and tell the model the data is fictional. If the model changes an identifier or number, reject the change and rerun with an explicit preserve-values instruction.

Quality control

- Your plan gives each stakeholder a specific frequency and channel, uses push and pull deliberately, and your three message versions genuinely differ in what they lead with.
- Compare the first AI draft with the final human-corrected artifact and retain both as evidence.
- Label assumptions, decisions, owners and dates so another project manager can audit the result.

Troubleshooting

If the response is generic, add the project objective, constraints, audience and required columns. If arithmetic is inconsistent, request formulas and substitutions, then calculate independently. If a source cannot be opened, remove the claim or replace it with verified evidence.

Submission evidence

Submit the completed project artifact, the final prompt, a short critique of the AI output, and any screenshot or exported file required by the activity.